

# Severe Weather & Shelter-in-Place

Quick actions for weather hazards, sheltering, and evacuation

Know your household's safe place, how you receive official alerts, and what to do before conditions become dangerous. Follow instructions from local officials whenever they differ from this guide.

Before severe weather

☐

 Turn on Wireless Emergency Alerts and choose trusted local weather/emergency sources.

☐

 Identify a safe room or shelter location for your household, visitors, and pets.

☐

 Keep flashlights, batteries, chargers, radio, water, medication, and shoes accessible.

☐

 Know two ways to receive alerts in case power, internet, or cell service fails.

☐

 Review evacuation routes, nearby safe destinations, and how household members will communicate.

Tornado or severe thunderstorm warning

■

**Go to a sturdy building** and move to a small interior room, hallway, bathroom, closet, or basement on the lowest level, away from windows.

■

**Protect your head and neck.** Take pets with you if you can do so safely.

■

**Monitor official alerts;** do not rely only on outdoor warning sirens.

Flooding, winter weather, wildfire smoke, and extreme heat

Know the hazard, know the response

■

**Flooding:** Move to higher ground when directed. Never drive, walk, or play in floodwater.

■

**Winter weather:** Stay off roads when possible, dress in layers, conserve heat safely, and monitor for signs of hypothermia or carbon-monoxide danger.

■

**Wildfire smoke:** Stay indoors when directed, close windows/doors, use clean indoor air practices, and follow local evacuation or air-quality guidance.

■

**Extreme heat:** Drink water, use air-conditioned spaces when available, check vulnerable people, and never leave people or pets in a parked vehicle.

Our household safe places and alerts

| Primary shelter / safe room | Backup location | How we receive alerts | Out-of-area contact |
|-----------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
|                             |                 |                       |                     |
|                             |                 |                       |                     |

Shelter-in-place and evacuation

Shelter in place when officials advise it

Bring people and pets inside.

Close and lock windows and exterior doors. Monitor official information.

If officials identify an airborne hazard,

follow their instructions about turning off heating/air-conditioning systems, closing vents, or sealing gaps.

Do not leave

until officials say it is safe.

Evacuate when directed

☐

Leave early if officials advise evacuation or if conditions make staying unsafe.

☐

Take your go-bag, medications, identification, emergency contacts, charger, and pet supplies.

☐

Use official routes and do not drive around barricades or through floodwater.

☐

Tell your out-of-area contact where you are going if it is safe to do so.

☐

Do not return until officials say the area is safe.

Household action plan

| Hazard / season | What we will do | Supplies or preparation needed | Who is responsible |
|-----------------|-----------------|--------------------------------|--------------------|
|                 |                 |                                |                    |
|                 |                 |                                |                    |
|                 |                 |                                |                    |

!

Call 911 for an immediate life-safety emergency. For weather updates and evacuation instructions, rely on local emergency management, law enforcement, fire officials, the National Weather Service, and other official sources.